- Hot and cold applications must be very carefully used when the clients is unconscious, anaesthetized or otherwise unable to respond pain.
- Any signs of complications should be recognized early, the procedure should be stopped immediately.
- After the procedure, dry the part gently by patting and not by rubbing to remove the moisture.
- In hyperpyrexia, the temperature of the body should be brought down gradually and steadily, sudden cooling is dangerous to the client.

3.1 Cold compresses

It is a local moist cold application. It may be sterile or unsterile. Sterile cold compresses are applied over open wounds or breaks in the skin. Cold compresses are made out of folded layers of gauze, lint piece or old soft linen, wring out of cold or ice water or in some evaporating lotion.

Article Required:

1. Large basin with ice.
2. Small basin with cold water.
3. Gauze pieces or small towels.
4. Waterproof pad.
5. Bath towel.

Procedure:

1. Explain the procedure to the client.
2. Wash hands.
3. Place the small basin with cold water into large basin with ice.
4. Place the compress in the cold water.
5. Keep the waterproof material under the part.
6. Check the area every 5 minutes.
7. Change the compress every 5 minutes or when it becomes hot.
8. Remove the compress after 20 minutes.
9. Put the area dry with a bath towel.
10. Make client comfortable.
11. Clean the equipment and place it in the proper place. Discard the used articles.
12. Wash hands
13. Document the care-time, site, duration of the application

Temperature for hot and cold applications

Sl.No	Description	Temperature	Application
1	Very cold	below15°c	Ice bag
2	cold	15-18°c	Cold packs
3	cool	18-27°c	Cold compress
4	tepid	27-37°c	Alcohol sponge bath
5	warm	37-40°c	Warm bath
6	hot	40-46°c	Hot soak , hot compress
7	Very hot	Above 46°c	Hot water bag for adult

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